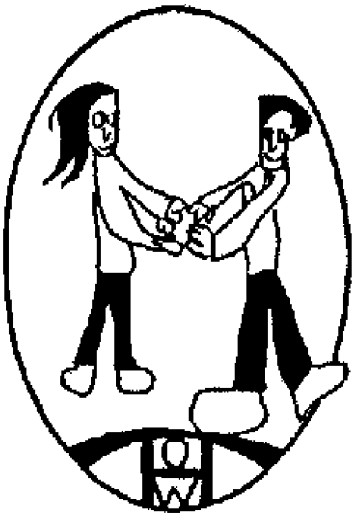
Howbridge Infant School



Design and Technology Policy

Date last reviewed by Governing Body: March 2026

Howbridge Infant School

POLICY NAME Design and Technology Policy
DATE OF REVIEW Spring 2026

Aims and priorities for subject teaching and learning
Design and Technology is taught as part of a broad and balanced curriculum. Our intent is for all children to develop the skills, knowledge and understanding needed for design and technology. Our aim is for children to think creatively, be inspired, engaged, and challenged in all lessons whilst applying new and revised skills. Our intent is for children to be able to solve problems as individuals and as part of a team, communicating effectively with each other and using key vocabulary. We want all children to be able to respond to a design brief with a range of ideas and systems. Children should combine practical skills with other needs such as function and aesthetics, and evaluate their work in a critical manner. Children should be able to explore and experiment with a variety of materials and tools, confidently applying them to their work. We would encourage children to be aware of how design reflects and shapes our everyday lives, and contribute to our diverse culture. As a school, we also promote the use of recycled materials in order to support sustainability. This may include using cardboard boxes and plastic materials. As part of design and technology, children are reminded of the importance of using the appropriate means for waste such as a food waste bin.
Sources used for the scheme of work
In the Early Years Foundation Stage teaching activities and learning objectives are taken from the Statutory Framework for the Early Years Foundation Stage December 2023. For Years 1 and 2 the basis for learning objectives and activities are set out within The Primary National Curriculum framework (2014). Cross curricular links to other subjects are made to create a more holistic approach to the curriculum. We follow the Kapow DT curriculum. Starting in reception, it provides a basis of key knowledge and skills, such as cutting, joining and using a variety of materials to construct such as junk modelling. The use of the scheme also promotes key vocabulary that the children need to know and that will support them through their design and technology education. We aim to give opportunities for children to revisit skills and knowledge that has been previously learnt as they progress through years 1 and 2. The Kapow scheme provides clear progression throughout the school and allows the exploration of different areas of DT, including food, textiles, woodwork and structures.
Strategies for teaching
Teaching strategies vary according to the needs of the class and the themes being taught. Class, group and individual teaching are used in a variety of activities. In the Foundation Stage, DT is taught through both adult led activities and continuous provision. We aim to provide lunchtime clubs relating to DT such as sewing, craft and Lego club, which are held during the year and support the development of skills. To promote sustainability, clubs such as Planet Protectors will also use recycled materials.
Planning, marking and feedback
We follow the Kapow DT curriculum map which outlines the skills and knowledge to be taught within each term and also identifies the end product. Each DT project follows the process of design, make and evaluate. Feedback is both formative and summative and is interactive; pupils are encouraged to evaluate theirs and others' work at all stages from design to completion. Evidence can be seen in class floorbooks and on Tapestry for the Early Years classes.
Assessment, recording and reporting

Assessments are made after each unit is completed using the schools assessment program (SONAR). This includes both formative and summative assessments. These are reviewed by subject leaders each half term, and are used to plan future actions within the DT action plan. Attainment is reported to parents at the end of each year, following school and National guidelines.
Across the school, each class has a floor book in which they document elements of the whole curriculum, including DT. In Key Stage 1, children also record some of their work in their Topic Books with clear DT objectives shown. Photographic evidence is kept of some activities (larger constructions) and this may be displayed in a class floor book. Parents can look at pupils' work at school events such as open mornings/afternoons and during Celebration assemblies.

Inclusion - equal opportunities, racial awareness, gender, higher potential, SEN

We aim to set suitable learning targets, respond to pupils' diverse needs and overcome potential barriers to learning for groups and individuals.
All children have equal access to activities, which are adapted if necessary for children with special needs – for example spring loaded scissors for children who have difficulty operating scissors. The school is sensitive to the needs of pupils from other ethnic groups or religions e.g. dietary rules and uses resources representative of various cultures where possible. Teachers adapt and extend tasks for children with special talents and abilities. Adaptations are outlined in the DT scheme.

Resource use, monitoring and acquisition

Resources are reviewed annually and matched to units of work. Each class is equipped with a range of DT equipment, which children can easily access. Some resources which are less frequently used or difficult to store are to be found centrally within the school (along the corridor next to Year 1, the Art cupboard is adjacent to class 3).

Links with other subjects

Design and Technology links naturally with Science and with the health and safety aspects of PSHE. Skills learned in other subjects, particularly English and Maths, are applied in units of work. Elements of PSHE can be incorporated into the schemes of work including collaborative working and health and safety. Speaking and listening objectives can also be applied to the children's work, as discussion often forms an integral part of the design making process. Children are also encouraged to listen carefully to others' suggestions and ideas, in order to evaluate and improve their own work. Design and technology also links to sustainability and the importance of recycling.

Thinking skills

The skills of Information processing, reasoning, enquiry, creative thinking, and evaluation are developed through our teaching and learning.
The problem solving elements of design and working to a brief are ideal to promote the development of thinking skills. Evaluation is a pivotal element of DT. These skills are further developed within clubs.

Monitoring and evaluation of teaching and learning

Procedures for monitoring teaching and learning are set out in subject, assessment and other support policies.
Planning and work samples are used for evidence in monitoring teaching and learning. Children complete each project and evidence is recorded in the class floor book or topic book (KS1), showing the knowledge and skills taught within sessions to help demonstrate progression. The skills required for DT are reviewed throughout the year, alongside the Kapow curriculum. The development of skills are regularly reviewed to ensure progression throughout the school. Subject leader reviews identify strengths and areas of development.

Staff and school development

These are planned for during the school year in order to meet the current needs of the school, including individual staff and year groups.

Review

This policy will be reviewed as part of the subject development programme. It will be re-drafted as necessary taking account of the school's development plan and new local and national curriculum requirements.
Natalie Pickess (DT subject leader)
Nicola Andrews (DT subject leader)